

PRE-SEED · CHENNAI · AUGUST 2026

Bolo Bill

The billing app for the shop that still bills on paper.

Speak, and the bill writes itself — in six Indian languages, on the phone the shopkeeper already owns.

Karthik Srinivasan · solo founder · working product, one live shop

THE PROBLEM

A doctor should look at the patient. A retailer should look at the customer.

Every billing system built for Indian retail asks the shopkeeper to look away — to find an item in a list, type a quantity, correct a typo — while a customer waits and three more queue behind.

So the shop that can least afford it keeps the notebook.

88% of Indian retail is still unorganised trade.

And it goes deeper than speed

The owner of our design partner — a working café — **does not know objectively what margin he makes.**

He is not unusual. Owners have neither the time nor the training to read a dashboard, so understanding of their own business is outsourced to an auditor once a quarter.

The gadget is between the retailer and the customer. The spreadsheet is between the owner and their own trade.

THE INSIGHT

Voice is not a feature here. It is the removal of the interface.

Nobody types

Not to bill. Not to add a product. Not to set a price. Typing is the fallback, never the default — which removes the literacy and typing-speed gate on who can staff a counter.

Nobody reads a dashboard

Ask the shop a question aloud, in your own language, and it answers. The same idea as billing by voice, applied to knowing your own numbers.

Nobody buys a terminal

The phone in their hand plus a ₹2,500 printer. The trial decision shrinks from a week's thought to a quiet hour.

The bar we hold ourselves to: faster than paper, or it does not ship. Not faster than a POS — *faster than the notebook it actually replaces.*

WHAT EXISTS TODAY — NOT A MOCKUP

A working product, live, with one real shop

~50

bills at Ragas Coffee
over one week

6

languages, code-mixed
Ta · En · Hi · MI · Te · Kn

1,561

automated tests
incl. 1,003-case matrix

₹0

raised to date
built solo

Shipped and working

Multi-item dictation in one breath · confidence gating · per-shop spoken aliases · UPI QR at the exact amount · cash settlement · customer recall by spoken number · numbered GST Bill of Supply, gapless under concurrency · WhatsApp receipt · hands-free wake word.

The signal inside the 50 bills

The operator moved from **press-to-talk to the wake word within that week**. Given a hands-free option, they took it.

Small numbers. But that is the thesis surviving one week of contact with a real counter.

MARKET

TAM / SAM / SOM — with the working shown

	Definition	Size	How we get there
TAM	India POS & retail-tech spend	US\$3.3B (2025), 11.5% CAGR	Mordor Intelligence. The whole category, hardware included.
SAM	Single-counter shops billing on paper — kirana, provision, small F&B	₹3,000–5,000 cr/yr ASSUMPTION	12–13M kirana × a ₹400/mo software line, discounted heavily for the share that will never adopt anything. Deliberately not "12M × our price".
SOM	3-year reachable with a services-constrained team	2,500 shops ≈ ₹1.4 cr ARR	From the model, not a percentage of TAM. 60 → 600 → 2,500, gated on a reseller channel that does not exist yet.

Context, not claim: only a small fraction of kirana had adopted a dedicated app historically, but 84% report starting *some* digital tool under quick-commerce pressure. The behaviour is changing; the billing counter is the part that has not.

COMPETITION

Nobody scaled runs voice as the primary interaction

Player	Price	Hardware capex	Voice	Offline
Bolo Bill	₹399 / ₹1,999 / ₹7,500	₹0–6,000	Native, core	Not yet — Phase 1
WeP Sol	Hardware + ₹7,000/yr AMC	₹9,990–37,000 machines; ₹52,990+ terminals	None	Yes
Petpooja	₹3,000–12,000/mo reported (unpublished) + 1.5–2%	Terminal or tablet	Add-on at best	Partial
Vyapar	Free + low paid	₹0	None — typed	Strong
GoFrugal	Mid-market ERP	Terminal	Rule-based only	Yes
Loyverse	Free; \$29/store	₹0	None	Yes

Where we lose today, stated first: Vyapar works with no network and we do not. For a kirana that is a disqualification, not a feature gap — which is why offline is the first thing this round buys.

ASR will commoditise. That is fine — it is not the moat.

What is not a moat

Voice recognition. Sarvam is a vendor; Bhashini and open on-device models are moving fast. Whatever we buy today is free tomorrow — for us *and* for Vyapar, who have the offline engine, the languages and the distribution already.

We plan against Vyapar shipping voice, not past it.

What is

1 • The per-shop alias catalog. Each shop teaches the system its own words for its own goods. After a month it knows that *this* shop's "aloo" is *that* SKU at *that* price. Switching cost the shop built themselves, invisible to a competitor quoting less.

2 • The corrected-utterance corpus. The only realistic route to an on-device model tuned to code-mixed retail speech — and therefore to ₹0 marginal inference.

These are the same asset. The moat and the cost structure are one thing.

BUSINESS MODEL

Priced against what the shop already pays — not against free

Single · ₹399/mo

One counter. Voice billing, GST receipt, ask-your-shop analytics.

Ragas pays WeP ₹583/mo in AMC today, on top of sunk capex, for a machine that cannot tell him his margin.

That is the reference price — not Vyapar's free tier.

Growing · ₹1,999/mo

2–10 outlets. Multi-counter, order management, CRM via RAGaaS, loyalty. Undercuts Petpooja's ₹3,000–12,000 band and includes what they bill as add-ons.

Chain · ₹7,500/mo

10+. HQ reporting, predictive replenishment, anomaly detection. **No product yet — Year 3**

Hardware kit sold at cost (~₹4,000), never at margin. It is an adoption lever and a support-cost control. The moment it earns margin we are carrying inventory, which is the thing this strategy exists to avoid.

The one number this business turns on

Today — cloud ASR

Typical shop, 1,500 bills/mo $\approx$ 6,000 utterances

−₹358

gross profit per shop per month. **Negative.** The ₹10/shop cost ceiling in our own design doc was right.

After the port — on-device

Same shop, same price, zero marginal inference

+₹362

91% gross margin. LTV ₹9,050 · CAC ₹800 · **11.3× LTV:CAC** · payback 2.2 months.

Break-even cloud rate is ₹0.0603 per utterance. Above it, Tier 1 cannot be profitable on cloud at any volume. We state it this way so the case does not rest on a vendor quote we have not yet validated — **this is what the round is for: moving inference on-device.** Not features.

What the shop gets back — and the honest caveat

Per month	Light (Ragas, 215 bills)	Typical (1,500)	Busy kirana (6,000)
Labour time released	₹69	₹481	₹1,923
WeP AMC avoided	₹583	₹583	₹583
Next machine avoided	₹200	₹200	₹200
Net of our ₹399	₹453	₹865	₹2,307
Kit payback	8.8 months	4.6 months	1.7 months

The caveat we lead with: at low volume the labour saving is small. A café does not buy this to save time — it buys it to stop paying the AMC, to avoid the next machine, and because the owner does not know his margins. **Time savings only dominate at kirana volume**, which is one more reason the beachhead is provision and kirana rather than cafés, despite our pilot being a café.

Channel, because founder-led does not reach 600 shops

0–6 mo · Founder-led

10 design partners in Chennai, at least half kirana. Not for revenue — for retention data and the correction corpus.

CAC ₹400, unscalable, and that is fine.

6–18 mo · Printer dealers

They already sell to this exact buyer, already visit, already answer the phone when hardware breaks. One curated kit, one commission.

CAC ₹1,200 · **unproven** — the biggest GTM assumption in the plan

18 mo+ · FMCG & ONDC

The distributor van already visits weekly. DigiDukaan targets 14M stores. Evaluate as distribution, not just context.

unvalidated

Onboarding must survive having no field force: install to first bill in under five minutes, unassisted, with support over WhatsApp in the shop's own language.

Every phase closes an evidence gap before it adds a feature

0–6 mo · this round

- Android app — offline billing, on-device wake word, Bluetooth Classic printing
- **On-device ASR spike** — beat ₹0.06/utterance
- Instrument what we have never measured
- Ask-your-shop analytics
- 10 design partners

6–18 mo · seed

- Tier 2: multi-counter, order management
- CRM **integrated** from RAGaaS, not built
- Inventory deduction, full tax invoice
- Reseller channel
- ~600 shops

18–36 mo

- Tier 3: HQ, predictive replenishment
- Languages 7+ (config, not code)
- ONDC / WhatsApp ordering
- Corpus at scale → better model
- ~2,500 shops

We will not: manufacture hardware · hold payment funds · chase Petpooja's F&B depth · sell shop data before the shop benefits.

RISKS

What could kill this — from us, not from your diligence

Risk	Honest position	Mitigation
On-device ASR misses accuracy	The whole cost structure depends on it. If a small quantised model cannot handle code-mixed retail speech, ₹0 inference fails and pricing must move.	Spike it in months 1–3, before headcount. Measurable early against the corpus we already collect.
Vyapar ships voice	Most likely competitive event. They have offline, languages, distribution and ledger data.	Alias catalog and corpus are per-shop and do not transfer. Depth of the no-typing model, not the presence of voice.
Retention unknown	One week at one shop tells us nothing. 4%/mo churn is the weakest number in the model.	10 partners for 8+ weeks is the gate on the next tranche.
Noise & accents unproven	Tested against a podcast, and against synthetic voices. Nobody but the founder has spoken to it.	Kirana pilots in real conditions in months 1–6; error rate instrumented.
Solo founder	Single point of failure, and no commercial co-founder.	First hire is engineering; a commercial partner is an explicit search, not a hope.

THE ASK

₹60 lakh pre-seed

Backed out of the 18-month plan, not rounded to a nice number. Funds Year 1 and Year 2 with headroom.

₹36L · Engineering

One ASR/Android engineer, 18 months. The on-device port is the round.

₹12L · Field

Onboarding lead from month 9; design-partner support before that.

₹8L · Infra & tools

Cloud, devices, printers, travel across Chennai shops.

₹4L · Buffer

Founder unpaid in Year 1. That is deliberate.

What it buys: offline billing, inference on-device and under break-even, 10 retained shops with measured error and churn — the four things that turn this from a working prototype into a fundable business.

Timing and founder-market fit

Why now

- Voice UPI has normalised speaking to a payment. The behaviour is no longer novel.
- Indic ASR crossed usable for code-mixed speech in the last 24 months.
- Quick commerce has pushed 84% of kirana into adopting *something* — defensively.
- 2025–26 Indian funding rewards unit economics over blitzscale. This plan is built that way rather than apologising for it.

Why me

- Built the whole product solo — six languages, tested grammar, live receipts, real shop.
- Also building RAGaaS, which supplies the CRM layer. The integration is not speculative.
- Chennai-based, in the market the product is designed for, in the language it is designed for.
- **Found and fixed three silent mispricing bugs before any customer met them.** That discipline is the product.

Faster than paper, or it does not ship.